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Step 4: Total all the amount columns. Total of debit total column and total of credit total column must be equal. Also total of debit balance column and total of credit balance column must be equal. If not equal, locate the errors and make the trial balance agree.

For the above example, trial balance will be prepared under total and balance method as follows:

S.No.	Particulars	L.F.	Debit total `	Credit total `	Debit balance `	Credit balance `
1	Cash A/c		5,56,800	23,000	5,33,800	-
2	Rathnakumar's capital A/c		-	5,00,000	-	5,00,000
3	Furniture A/c		6,000	-	6,000	-
4	Purchases A/c		35,000	-	35,000	-
5	Jeyanthi A/c		2,500	25,000	-	22,500
6	Purchases returns A/c		-	2,500	-	2,500
7	Sales A/c		-	1,04,000	-	1,04,000
8	Elizabeth A/c		72,000	22,000	50,000	-
9	Salaries A/c		7,000	2,800	7,000	-
10	Commission A/c		-	-	-	2,800
	Total		**6,79,300**	**6,79,300**	**6,31,800**	**6,31,800**

Note: Students will be tested on balance method only

5.8 Suspense account



Student activity

Think: Do you think the trial balance tallies all the time? What should be done when it does not tally?

After transferring all the ledger account balances, if the trial balance does not tally, steps must be taken to locate and rectify errors. If the errors cannot be rectified, then trial balance is tallied by transferring the difference between the total of debit balances and the total of credit balances to a temporary account, called suspense account for timely preparation of the financial statements. If the trial balance shows lesser debit total, suspense account will be debited. Similarly, if the trial balance shows lesser credit total, suspense account will be credited. Later, when errors are located and rectified, the trial balance will get tallied.

Illustration 1

State whether the balance of each of the following accounts should be placed in the debit or the credit column of the trial balance:

1) Sundry debtors 2) Sundry creditors 3) Cash in hand 4) Bank overdraft
5) Salary 6) Discount allowed 7) Plant and machinery 8) Furniture